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STAFF REPORT

Date: October 7, 2025

To: Portland Public Schools Board of Directors

CC: Dr, Kimberlee Armstrong, Superintendent

From: Kristina Howard, Senior Chief of Academics

Subject: Resolution to Approve Postponement of the Regular Purchase of State-Adopted Instructional Materials

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BACKGROUND

Portland Public Schools (PPS) is committed to adopting and implementing high-quality, culturally responsive instructional materials to meet the diverse learning needs of all students**.**

The Oregon Department of Education establishes an adoption cycle for instructional materials by content area. The current PPS schedule includes:

- **Social Studies (K-12):** This is a two-year adoption plan:
  - **Grades 6–12** materials are scheduled for adoption in the **2025–26** school year.
  - **K–5** materials are scheduled for adoption in the **2026–27** school year.
- **Health (K–12):** Adoption is underway, with materials scheduled for board approval in **Spring 2026** and full implementation in **Fall 2026**.

Ongoing Work and Timeline Updates

PPS has ongoing work and proposed timeline changes in the following areas:

- **Social Emotional Learning (SEL) (9–12):** Curriculum pilots are underway. Full implementation is expected in seven comprehensive high schools, with the remaining high schools on track for **2026–27** implementation.
- **Health (K–12):** While the adoption process has begun, **additional time is required** to complete field testing and community engagement fully.
- **Social Studies (K-5):** A proposal for a **one-year postponement** (for K-5 only) of the adoption timeline is scheduled for presentation and Board approval in **Spring 2027**. Full implementation would remain in the **2027-2028** school year.

Oregon Revised Statute (ORS) 337.120 permits districts to postpone the regular purchase of state-adopted instructional materials for up to two years following the beginning of the school year after the state adoption.

RELATED POLICIES / BEST PRACTICES

This recommendation aligns with PPS policy regarding the adoption of instructional materials and Oregon Department of Education guidance under ORS 337.120.

ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

The district's curriculum adoption cycle for K–5 Social Studies is intended to be a two part process, starting with 6-12 and adding in K-5 the second year. This is allowable per state approved allowances and requires board approval. K–12 Health adoption is in progress but requires additional time for completion.

Postponing the regular purchase under ORS 337.120 provides the flexibility necessary to complete these adoptions. During the postponement period, PPS will continue using currently approved instructional materials and pilot resources to maintain continuity of instruction.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION / EVALUATION

- **2025–26:** Completion of K–12 Health; Board presentation and adoption of K-12 Health materials.
- **2026-27**: Completion of K-5 Social Studies; Board presentation and adoption of K-5 Social Studies
- **2026–27:** Full implementation of Health K-12 materials.
- **2027-28:** Full implementation of Social Studies K-5 materials.
- **Ongoing:** Continued implementation and support of 9–12 Social Emotional Learning curriculum with full implementation achieved **Fall 2026**.

BOARD OPTIONS WITH ANALYSIS

Option 1: Approve the postponement of regular purchase of state-adopted instructional materials for K–5 Social Studies and extended timeline for Health K-12, and Social Emotional Learning 9-12, as permitted under ORS 337.120. This aligns with our internal PPS adoptions schedule for Social Studies K-5 and allows the flexibility needed to complete our Health adoption K-12 and 9-12 Social Emotional Learning curriculum selection and implementation.

Option 2: Deny the postponement request for K-5 Social Studies would require adjustments to our Bond 2025 Curriculum schedule and intentionality of a Part 1 and Part 2 of a core adoption as planned. Teams would need to refocus efforts to accomplish the work this year and there would be budgetary implications for extended hours for teacher participation in the adoption process.

STAFF RECOMMENDATION

Staff recommends that the Board of Education approve the postponement of the regular purchase of state-adopted instructional materials for K–5 Social Studies and the extended

timeline for K–12 Health and 9-12 Social Emotional Learning as outlined, pursuant to ORS 337.12.

ATTACHMENTS

A. Resolution to Approve Postponement of the Regular Purchase of State-Adopted Instructional Materials Pursuant to ORS 337.120